

Business Architecture

Business Objective

The Award Nomination App enables organizations to run employee recognition programs with configurable rules, controlled approval workflows, fraud-aware monitoring, and auditable payout processing.

The business architecture centers on four outcomes:

- Make employee recognition easier to submit and approve.
- Protect recognition budgets from abuse, favoritism, and inconsistent decisions.
- Give HR and executives visibility into recognition behavior.
- Support tenant-specific rules without creating separate products per customer.

Business Capabilities

Capability	Description
Nomination management	Create, submit, approve, reject, and track employee award nominations.
Tenant configuration	Configure tenant branding, domain, locale, currency, award limits, categories, certificates, and description rules.
Identity and roster alignment	Map signed-in Entra ID users to tenant-scoped application users and manager relationships.
Approval workflow	Route nominations to the beneficiary manager for approval after integrity checks.
HRBP review	Route risky or suspicious nominations to HRBP users before manager approval.
Integrity analytics	Detect abnormal behavior, duplicate descriptions, graph patterns, and suspicious approval behavior.
Notification management	Send manager approval requests, outcome emails, HRBP alerts, access requests, and payroll failure notices.
Payroll coordination	Submit approved awards to payroll providers through a broker and track payout status.
Executive analytics	Provide spend trends, top recipients, top nominators, fraud alerts, approval metrics, diversity metrics, category breakdown, and forecasts.
Investigation support	Provide admin-facing AI ask and investigate workflows with export support.
Auditability	Preserve impersonation audit logs, event processing logs, workflow status, fraud scores, HRBP decisions, and payout references.

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Needs
Employee nominator	Simple nomination flow, clear award limits, responsive feedback, history tracking.
Beneficiary	Recognition and optional certificate or payout notification.
Manager approver	Clear approval queue, context, email action links, reject reason capture.
HRBP reviewer	Review queue for suspicious nominations, fraud explanations, pair history, approve/reject decisions.
Payroll BP	Pay-data lookup and confidence that approved awards reach payroll.

Stakeholder	Needs
Tenant administrator	Branding, user roles, impersonation support, analytics, logs, and tenant-specific configuration.
Executive sponsor	Spend, fairness, fraud risk, forecast, trend, and operational visibility.
Platform operator	Deployment, health, logs, traces, alerting, rollback, and cost controls.
Security/compliance reviewer	Tenant isolation, identity controls, auditability, secrets management, and AI governance.

Tenant Model

The tenant is the primary business boundary. The platform maps each Entra ID tenant GUID to an internal **TenantId** in the **Tenants** table.

Tenant-specific configuration includes:

- Tenant name.
- Azure AD tenant ID.
- Domain.
- Site URL.
- Branding colors and logo.
- Locale and currency.
- Award minimum and maximum.
- Nomination categories.
- Description quality policy.
- Certificate settings.
- Integrity routing thresholds.
- Payroll provider configuration.

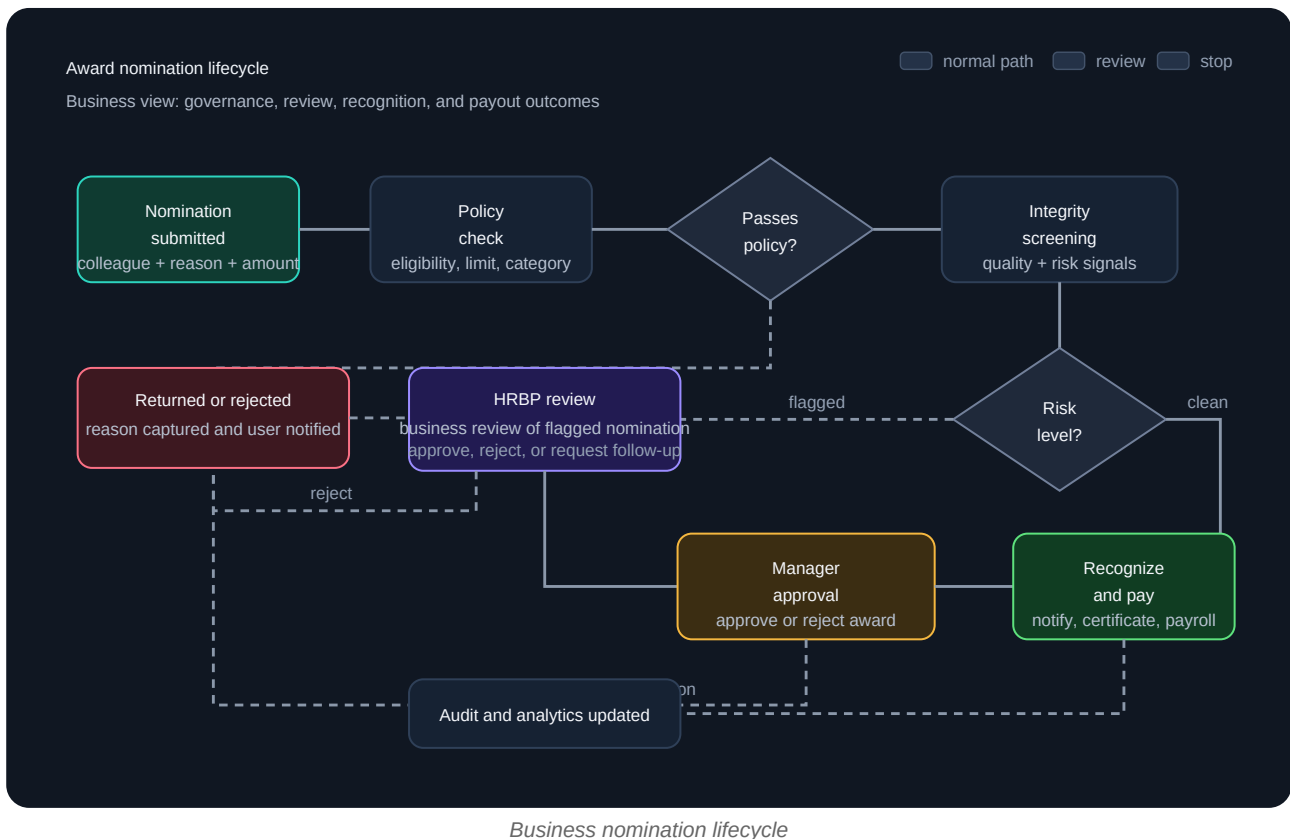
Business rule: users from an unregistered Entra tenant are rejected. Users from a registered tenant must also exist in that tenant roster.

User Personas and Roles

Role	Source	Business function
Standard user	Tenant roster and Entra token	Submit nominations, view history, approve if manager.
Manager approver	Manager relationship in Users.ManagerId	Approve or reject beneficiary nominations.
HRBP	Application role in UserRoles	Review flagged nominations.
PayrollBP	Application role in UserRoles	Access payroll lookup and payout context.
Admin	Entra app role such as Award_Nomination_Admin	Analytics, impersonation, audit logs, model refresh, nomination logs.
Support	Application role in UserRoles	Receive payroll failure notifications where configured.

Nomination Lifecycle

Business-facing lifecycle view. Technical workflow views are covered in the Solution Architecture document.



Business Rules

Nomination Rules

- A nomination must have a beneficiary, amount, and description.
- The amount must fall within tenant-specific bounds.
- The beneficiary must belong to the same tenant.
- The beneficiary must have a manager assigned.
- If tenant categories exist, **CategoryId** is required and must be valid for the tenant.
- Descriptions must satisfy tenant-specific word or character count policy.
- Boilerplate phrases can be blocked synchronously.

Integrity Rules

- Submitted nominations are screened asynchronously.
- Semantic description checks can reject or flag nominations before manager review.
- ML fraud scoring uses tenant-specific models when available.
- Routing thresholds can be tenant-specific.
- HRBP decisions create labels that feed future model training.

Approval Rules

- Only the assigned approver can approve or reject a manager approval item.
- Reject decisions capture reason and actor.

- Approved items can generate certificates if the tenant enables the feature.
- Approved items trigger notification and payout processing.

Admin Rules

- Admin access is based on Entra app roles.
- Admin impersonation is tenant-scoped and audited.
- Admin analytics are tenant-scoped.

Exception Handling

Exception	Business behavior
Unknown tenant	Reject login with 403.
User not in tenant roster	Reject login with 404.
Wrong domain	Frontend shows wrong-portal guidance based on tenant config.
Missing manager	Reject nomination submission.
Invalid category	Reject nomination submission.
Description fails policy	Reject or route according to description/integrity configuration.
Fraud model unavailable	Route conservatively as clean while logging model unavailable behavior.
Service Bus publish failure	API logs warning; nomination remains saved and can be recovered operationally.
Duplicate Service Bus delivery	Workers use ProcessedEvents for idempotent side effects.
Payroll submission failure	Broker publishes payroll.failed ; auxiliary worker notifies support roles.

Value Proposition by Stakeholder

Stakeholder	Value
Employees	Easy recognition submission and transparent status tracking.
Managers	Clear decision queue and email-based action support.
HRBP	Focused review of high-risk items instead of reviewing every award.
Payroll	Cleaner handoff from approved recognition to off-cycle bonus processing.
Executives	Spend, fairness, risk, and forecast visibility.
Tenant admins	Configurable, branded, multilingual recognition workflow.
Security and audit teams	Tenant isolation, RBAC, audit logs, and traceable event processing.